



I Had a Pulpit—And I Still Do



Matt & Heather Headley
Jul 1, 2025

Edit



A couple Sundays ago, I stood in the pulpit at Jacksonville First Presbyterian Church and preached a Father's Day sermon for Trinity Sunday. It was a sacred surprise—the kind of gift you don't know you need until you're mid-sentence and realize you've come home.

Not just to a church building, but to a voice.

I preached about fatherhood, about the mystery of a God who is Three-in-One, and about what it costs to show up with your full heart in seasons of unraveling.

The service was livestreamed—so yes, it's still floating around the digital heavens—but the deeper sermon? That one's still unfolding. In our finances. In our field rows. In our healing.

And honestly, it keeps preaching to me.

🕊️ Scripture That's Holding Me:

One scripture keeps echoing in my mind—Romans 5:3–5 from the Common English Bible:

"But not only that! We even take pride in our problems, because we know that trouble produces endurance, endurance produces character, and character produces hope. This





hope doesn't put us to shame, because the love of God has been poured out in our hearts through the Holy Spirit, who has been given to us."

We've had a lot of anxiety lately—about money, about Heather's health, about slow sales, parenting, and all the things you don't see on Instagram. But this scripture, and this sermon, keep showing up for me.

Even now, something is growing.

What We're Building:

Since that Sunday, I've been reflecting on what it means to carry a pulpit with me. To keep pastoring—even without a robe or a title or a church budget. To speak from spreadsheets. From soil. From the Bloom Bar, where we sell flowers at the market. From this very post.

Because the truth is: **I'm still preaching.**

Through content. Through conversation. Through the hard work of rebuilding after burnout, debt, and deep grief.

Heather and I prepaid our team through the fall (via a PayPal credit line), and we're dreaming up workshops and events again. We're current on our bills, but it's tight—every dollar is weighted with intention.

Every bit of support you give helps hold up that invisible pulpit.

Why Patreon?

I'm reopening this space as a kind of mobile tabernacle—a place to share not just farm news, but the living sermons that unfold in real time.

If you're here reading this, you're part of that resurrection story.

Maybe you came for the blooms. Maybe the music, or the prayers, or the grit. However you landed here—thank you. You're helping us tell the truth and keep going.

Ways to Support:

- **Rooted Friend – \$5/month**

For those quietly undergirding the work.

- **Blooming Circle – \$25/month**

For those helping the work bear fruit and beauty.

Want to Hear the Sermon That Sparked This Post?

I preached "*When Wisdom Played*" at Jacksonville First Presbyterian on Trinity Sunday.

You can watch the full service here—my sermon begins at **15:45**:

👉 [Watch the livestream](#)

It's about shawls, suffering, dancing, and the kind of hope that blooms even in cracked clay.

🌱 **Pause & Reflect:**

Where is *Wisdom* showing up in your life right now?

In laughter? In waiting? In quiet second chances?

If the Trinity isn't a riddle to solve but a relationship to join—what's the next step of your dance?

🗨️ **Closing Word:**

The pulpit isn't gone. It's just mobile now.

And I'm committed to using it—here, with you—for healing, connection, and holy mischief.

Thanks for sticking with us through both the mess and the miracle.

P.S. If you've been following our journey in the wider world, you might've seen our recent reflections in the [Anniston Star](#). We've had pieces published the past couple months, sharing more of our story in the community—if you'd like the links, I'm happy to pass them along.

With grace and grit,

Matt

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LOCAL FARMS

At this local family flower farm, it's all hands on deck

By Faith Dorn May 7, 2025 2 min to read

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(From left) Sage, Soren, Hannah, Matt and Noah Headley, with Luna the dog. The kids are sitting on rolls of cardboard the Headleys use in the gardening process.

Posted Jul 1, 2025 at 7:11 PM

📖 2

2 comments



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What a powerful reflection, praying God keeps showing you a way forward with the blessings needed for abundance in all things!

1 heart 1 reply



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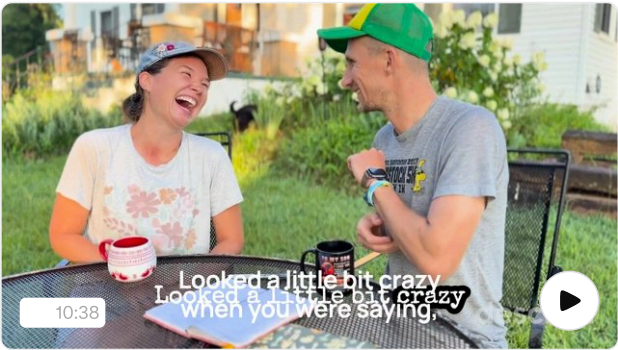


Thanks, Lin! We appreciate your prayers and encouragement!



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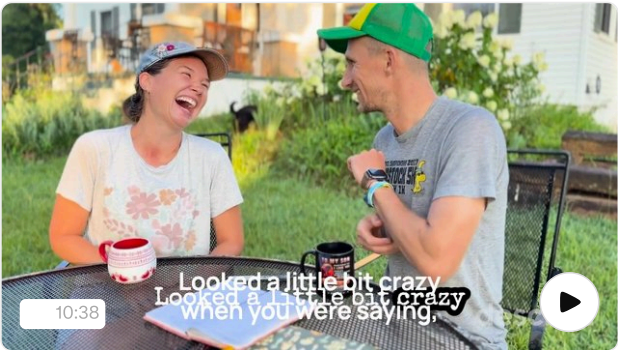
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